

Catherine Varas

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📍 Australia

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Resume

I'm a Data Engineer with four years of experience in cloud data engineering, process automation, large-scale data migrations, and backend development in Java. I bring hands-on expertise in Java, Spark, SQL, Python, Docker, and Azure,

I'm driven by innovation and continuous improvement, collaborating across teams to deliver large-scale projects that create real impact. I combine strong technical expertise with analytical research skills, adaptability, and a proactive mindset to design and build data platforms that empower analytics, enable AI integration, and drive technological transformation.

With over two years of experience in the financial sector's data engineering initiatives, I played a key role in the core banking migration to the cloud at BBVA, one of the largest banks in Latin America.

I'm currently entering my final semester of a Master's in Data Science at the University of Queensland. I'm now seeking Data Engineering roles in the finance sector, where I can contribute technical excellence, a collaborative attitude, and a strong drive for innovation and continuous improvement.

Full time work rights: I'll have full-time work rights from November 18th to February 23rd (semester break), and I'm open to sponsorship opportunities during my last semester (February 23rd to May 29th).

Key Skills & Tools

- **Data Engineering & Programming:** Java, Python, Apache Spark, ETL pipelines, legacy migration, schema validation, Databricks
- **Cloud & Infra:** Azure (Data Factory, Fabric, VM), AWS
- **AI & Automation:** Spark MLlib, scikit-learn, MLOps, Copilot Studio, Azure AI Foundry, Generative AI (LLMs), Prompt Engineering, R, MATLAB
- **DevOps, Containerization & Orchestration:** Docker, Kubernetes, Power Automate, CI/CD (Jenkins, Bitbucket, Azure DevOps, Git), Control-M
- **BI & Visualization:** Power BI, Streamlit, Tableau, Looker, QlikView, HTML/CSS
- **Legacy & Databases :** IBM Mainframe, Oracle, MySQL, PostgreSQL, Snowflake, GraphQL
- **Scripting & Integration:** Bash, Google Apps Script, REST APIs, Linux

Education

Master in Data Science | University of Queensland | February 2025 – June 2026

- Coursework: Cloud Computing (Kubernetes, Docker), Machine Learning, Data Analytics, Artificial Intelligence

Bachelor of Industrial Engineering | Peruvian University of Applied Sciences | 2019 – 2023

- Coursework: Project & Quality Management, Process Optimization, Systems Design & Integration

Associate's Degree in Computer Science | Institute Cibertec | 2019 – 2022

- Coursework: SQL, Java, Python, C#, Oracle, Web Development, Business Process Modelling

Experience

Data Engineering (Internship Placement)

One51 | Data & Analytics Consultancy

Sydney, Australia

July 2025 – Present

- Developed Python scripts to analyze and process metadata, supporting the migration of reports from QlikView to Power BI and built an interactive Streamlit app to visualize metadata insights and highlight gaps in data migration.
- Implemented a Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) framework in Azure Foundry to automatically translate QlikView formulas and queries into Power BI formats, improving accuracy and efficiency.

Associate Data Engineer

BBVA Perú

Lima, Perú

June 2024 – January 2025

- Led the migration of millions of contractual records from IBM Mainframe systems to a cloud-based data infrastructure, leveraging Apache Spark for large-scale data transformation, orchestrating batch processes through Control-M.
- Designed and implemented robust frameworks to ensure data quality, scalability, and strict compliance with banking security and regulatory standards.
- Developed Java backend routines to operate within a coexistence model to dynamically querying Mainframe or Oracle systems depending on data recency.
- Oversaw the integration of banking applications with the contract module, guiding projects to identify and reuse backend components where needed.
- Managed the development and maintenance of the contracts module consisting of a centralized database and backend routines that exposed contract information across systems, promoting modularity, ensuring data consistency and significantly reducing technical debt and delivery time across squads.

Junior Data Engineer

BBVA Perú

Lima, Perú

October 2022 – June 2024

- Built data pipelines with Apache Spark to move banking product data to the cloud, ensuring reliable and high-performance processing of contract information throughout its lifecycle.
- Developed reusable Spark processes to clean, validate, and load data in Parquet format, then packaged them for automated scheduling in Control-M and deployment through CI/CD pipelines.
- Automated data quality and anomaly checks using a parameterized Spark process, ensuring accuracy, consistency, and regulatory compliance across millions of contract records.
- Executed full testing lifecycle, including unit, integration, performance, and user testing, across multiple environments, optimizing system stability and throughput for high-volume workloads.
- Deployed, tested and maintained over 70 components spanning Java backend routines, Spark batch processes, and database scripts for the contract lifecycle module, driving standardization, maintainability, and faster delivery.
- Deployed microservices in containers to simplify scaling and maintenance.
- Collaborated with international teams (Colombia, Mexico, Spain) to align solution designs, coordinate integrations, and resolve data migration challenges.

Cloud Computing Intern

Kyndryl

Lima, Perú

February 2022 – October 2022

- Conducted architectural analysis for disaster recovery and contingency datacenter strategies, aligning with business continuity requirements.
- Delivered cloud-based solutions on Azure tailored to client needs and operational constraints.
- Contributed to a Data Engineering community, sharing knowledge and applying best practices to real-world projects.

Business Intelligence Analyst

Vida Software

Lima, Perú

July 2021 – February 2022

- Refined and processed Big Data for performance reporting and operational insights.
- Developed Python scripts to automate repetitive tasks and optimize workflows.
- Automated daily review and processing of SFTP files, improving reliability and speed.
- Built integration pipelines and scripts to transfer data between Hasura GraphQL and SQL Server.
- Automated the email dispatch system for client notifications, enhancing communication efficiency.
- Updated backend services (Node.js) and frontend components (Vue.js) of the main portal.
- Designed dashboards and data-driven solutions to optimize planning and forecasting for retail clients.

Certifications | [Link](#)

- Academy Accreditation - Generative AI Fundamentals | [Link](#)
- Microsoft Certified: Fabric Data Engineer Associate (DP700) | [Link](#)
- Microsoft Certified: Fabric Analytics Engineer Associate (DP600) | [Link](#)
- Microsoft Certified: Power BI Data Analyst Associate (PL300) | [Link](#)
- AWS Cloud Practitioner | [Link](#)
- Microsoft Azure Fundamentals | [Link](#)